Branding & Promotion

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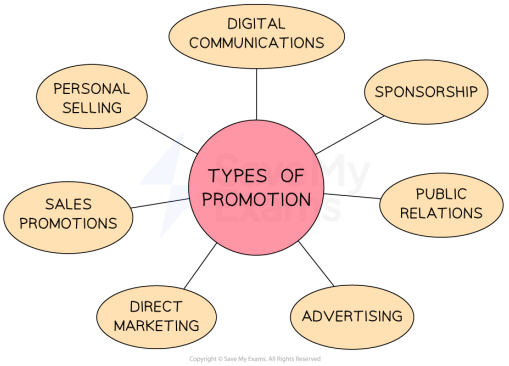
Types of promotion

- Promotion is an important element of the marketing mix, as it plays a crucial role in **generating customer awareness**, interest and desire for a product/service
  - A business can communicate its **value proposition** to potential customers and differentiate itself from competitors
  - Promotion helps to **build brand awareness and loyalty**, which can lead to repeat purchases and referrals
- The promotion element of the marketing mix includes a **variety of promotional methods**

Types of promotion



The different types of promotional methods available to a business to communicate with its target market

- Each method has advantages and disadvantages associated with its use
- Businesses must select the **most appropriate methods** for their product/service, target audience and budget

An assessment of promotional strategies

Method	Advantages	Disadvantages
Advertising • Promotion through **paid channels** such	• Can reach large audiences and increase	• Can be expensive • The effectiveness

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

(magazines) and online advertising	used to **create a specific brand image** or message (e.g. the advertising campaign run by Compare the Market (Meerkat))	**measure** • Many customers tune out or ignore ads
Direct marketing • Communicating directly with customers through emails, text messages, social media or posts	• Businesses can **target specific audiences** and personalise their message to individual customers • Direct marketing is also **measurable**, which enables businesses to track their results and adjust their strategy accordingly	• Can be intrusive, as customers may perceive it as spam • Can also be costly, especially if businesses **do not have an established customer database** or need to purchase leads
Sales promotions • Techniques that encourage the purchase of a product by offering temporary incentives or discounts such as free samples, **buy one get one free**, discount coupons, loyalty cards and rebates (customers have to mail in to receive money back)	• Can quickly boost sales or customer engagement • Can help to **clear out stock** or promote a new product • Can encourage **impulse purchases** • Can be targeted to specific segments of customers	• Can be expensive, especially if the promotion requires heavy discounting • Can attract **deal-seeking customers** who may not be loyal to the brand • May reduce the sales of full-priced products

salesperson interacts with potential **customers one on one**, either in person or through digital communication channels	**relationships** with their customers and understand their specific needs • Enables businesses to provide **personalised advice and guidance** to customers	cost of **hiring and training sales staff** • The impact of personal selling can be limited, as it is **difficult to scale** to large audiences
Sponsorship • An agreement in which a company provides **financial or other support** to an event, team or organisation in exchange for marketing exposure • Can take many forms, such as **logo placement or naming rights** (e.g. Arsenal's Emirates Stadium)	• Can help to **build brand awareness** and credibility • Can **create emotional connections** with target audiences • Can support specific business objectives, such as entering new markets or **reaching new customers**	• Can be expensive, especially for high-profile events or properties • May not directly drive sales • May be **subject to negative publicity** if the sponsored entity experiences a scandal or controversy (e.g. In 2022, Kanye West was dropped by Adidas after his antisemitic outbursts)

• Building relationships with the public and managing reputation • Public relations activities can include **media relations, crisis management and community outreach** • For example, in 2018, KFC in Ireland ran out of chicken due to some supply chain issues and ran a **brilliant PR strategy** in which it rearranged the letters in its name to "FCK" and owned the problem	reputation and credibility • This can lead to **increased customer loyalty** and sales • Can be cost-effective when compared to advertising or personal selling	**scheduling**, and it is difficult to measure the direct impact of PR activities on profits
Digital communications • Any form of marketing or communication that is delivered electronically, such as social media, search engine optimisation or **mobile apps such as Instagram and Twitter** • Can be used for building brand awareness, generating leads or driving sales	• Can be highly targeted to **specific customer segments** • Can provide **real-time engagement and feedback** from customers	• Can be easily ignored or filtered out by customers • May require **significant investment in technology** or data infrastructure • May be subject to data privacy regulations or security breaches • May **not be effective for reaching older** or less digitally savvy customer segments

Help me understand

Types of branding

competitors
- Branding is important to a business for a variety of reasons:
  - Branding establishes **recognition and identity**
  - Branding builds trust and credibility
  - Branding **differentiates** a business from its competitors
  - Branding creates an emotional connection with customers that helps to **generate repeat purchases**
  - Branding **supports marketing and advertising** efforts

Types of branding

The three different types of branding available to businesses

Manufacturer/corporate branding

- This refers to the use of a company name or logo to **promote all the products or services offered by the company**
- This type of branding is used by companies such as Nestlé, Nike and Apple

Advantages and disadvantages of corporate branding

Advantages	Disadvantages

company, which can increase customer loyalty and trust • Allows the company to leverage its **existing reputation** and customer base to **introduce new products** more easily • Helps build **economies of scale** by **promoting multiple products** under one brand, which can reduce marketing costs and increase profitability	**impact on all the products** offered under that brand • If the company faces intense competition in one market (e.g. smartphones), it **may affect the sales of all the products** offered across other markets (e.g. laptops and desktops)

Product branding

- This refers to the use of a unique name, design or symbol to promote a specific product
- For example, KitKat, Coca-Cola and the McDonald's Big Mac

Advantages and disadvantages of product branding

Advantages	Disadvantages
• Creates a distinct identity for the product, which can help to **differentiate it from competitors** and increase brand loyalty • Allows the company to market different products to different segments of the market (e.g. Coca-Cola and Coke Zero) • Can help build customer loyalty and trust by associating the **product with a specific quality** and benefits (e.g. Dyson vacuum cleaners)	• The cost of creating and promoting **a new brand for each product** can be expensive • Introducing new products under different brands is difficult, as the business must **build a new brand for each product** from scratch • Different products within the brand may have **different levels of quality**, which can affect customer satisfaction

Own branding

- **Own-brand** or **private-label branding** refers to the use of a retailer's name to promote a specific product or service
  - Own branding is often used by supermarkets, such as Asda chocolate, Tesco's "Finest" range and Sainsbury's "Basics" range

Advantages	Disadvantages
• They can help **retailers differentiate themselves** from their competitors by offering unique products • They allow retailers to offer products at a lower cost than branded products, which can help to increase sales and profitability • They can help **build customer loyalty** by offering exclusive products that are not available elsewhere	• Own-brand products may have a **lower perceived quality** than branded products, which can affect customer loyalty and trust

The benefits of branding

- Strong branding can provide several benefits to a business, including:

Added value

- Strong branding can **add value** to a product by creating a perception of quality, reliability and trust

Ability to charge premium prices

- Customers may be **willing to pay more** for a product that is associated with a **well-established brand**
- They perceive products with strong branding to be of higher quality and therefore worth the extra cost

Reduced price elasticity of demand

- Strong branding can also reduce the price elasticity of demand for a product (customers are less sensitive to price changes)
- This is because customers who are **loyal to a brand** are more likely to continue purchasing the product even if the price increases

Ways to build a brand

- Brands can be built using **any one or a combination** of the following methods:
  - By developing unique selling points (USPs)
  - Through advertising
  - Through sponsorship
  - Through the use of social media

Unique selling points (USPs)	• USPs are the features that make a product/service **stand out** from its competitors • Brands can build their reputation by **emphasising these unique qualities** in their marketing efforts	• Apple is known for its innovative and **sleek design and use of quality materials**, which sets its products apart from its competitors • The company has built its brand around this USP and is recognised worldwide for its **premium design**
Advertising	• Brands can **create compelling ads** that resonate with their target audience, raise brand awareness and communicate their value proposition • With the **right advertising strategy**, brands create a strong emotional connection with their audience and inspire brand loyalty	• Coca-Cola has successfully built its brand through advertising • Iconic ads over the years have become synonymous with the brand • For example, the "**Share a Coke**" campaign encouraged people to buy Coca-Cola bottles with their friends' names on them and was a massive success
Sponsorship	• Partnering with events, organisations or individuals can **help brands gain exposure and build their reputation** by aligning themselves with positive	• Nike has **sponsored many high-profile athletes** and sports events, such as the Olympics and the World Cup • Nike has built a reputation for being a brand

		and inspires people to be their best
Social media	• With the right social media strategy, brands can build a loyal following and **create a community around their brand**	• Glossier has a strong presence on platforms such as Instagram, and it engages with its audience and shares user-generated content • Glossier's social media strategy has helped the brand **build a loyal following**

Changes in branding and promotion to reflect social trends

- Businesses that respond quickly to **changing social trends** can better meet the needs of customers
- Being able to quickly adapt branding and promotion strategies helps **maximise communication opportunities with customers**, which can develop brand loyalty and increase profits
- Three current social trends businesses are aware of and adapting to are viral marketing, the use of social media and emotional branding

Viral marketing

- This is a strategy in which businesses use online platforms to promote products by **creating content at specific times**, which can easily be shared and commented on
    - For example, during the Covid-19 pandemic, Coca-Cola and McDonald's **ran campaigns that emphasised community**, which aligned with the public's need for social support

Social media

- As social media platforms evolve, businesses must also **adapt their social media strategies** to keep up with the latest trends

- More recently, many businesses have shifted focus to promoting their brands through **short-form video** content on platforms such as **TikTok**

Emotional branding

- Emotional branding is a strategy in which companies **build strong emotional connections** with customers by appealing to their values, beliefs and emotions
  - For example, brands such as Patagonia and TOMS have built entire brand identities around a strong commitment to environmental and social causes, which **resonates with customers** who prioritise these values

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